

IN PROFILE

Sviatoslav Richter

Prokofiev had close links with some leading Soviet musicians, especially Sviatoslav Richter (1915–1997), widely regarded as one of the greatest pianists of the 20th century. Richter gave the first performances of several of Prokofiev's works, including the Piano Sonata No. 7 in 1943. It is one of three piano sonatas Prokofiev wrote during World War II and Richter spoke of it reflecting the anxieties of a world in which "chaos and uncertainty reign." However, he also thought it expressed a "will for victory" and affirmed "the irrepressible life force."



SOVIET MUSICIAN SVIATOSLAV RICHTER AT
THE PIANO

Prokofiev's career divides into three distinct phases. In the first phase, during the period leading up to the Russian Revolution in 1917, he was a provocative firebrand emerging as one of the